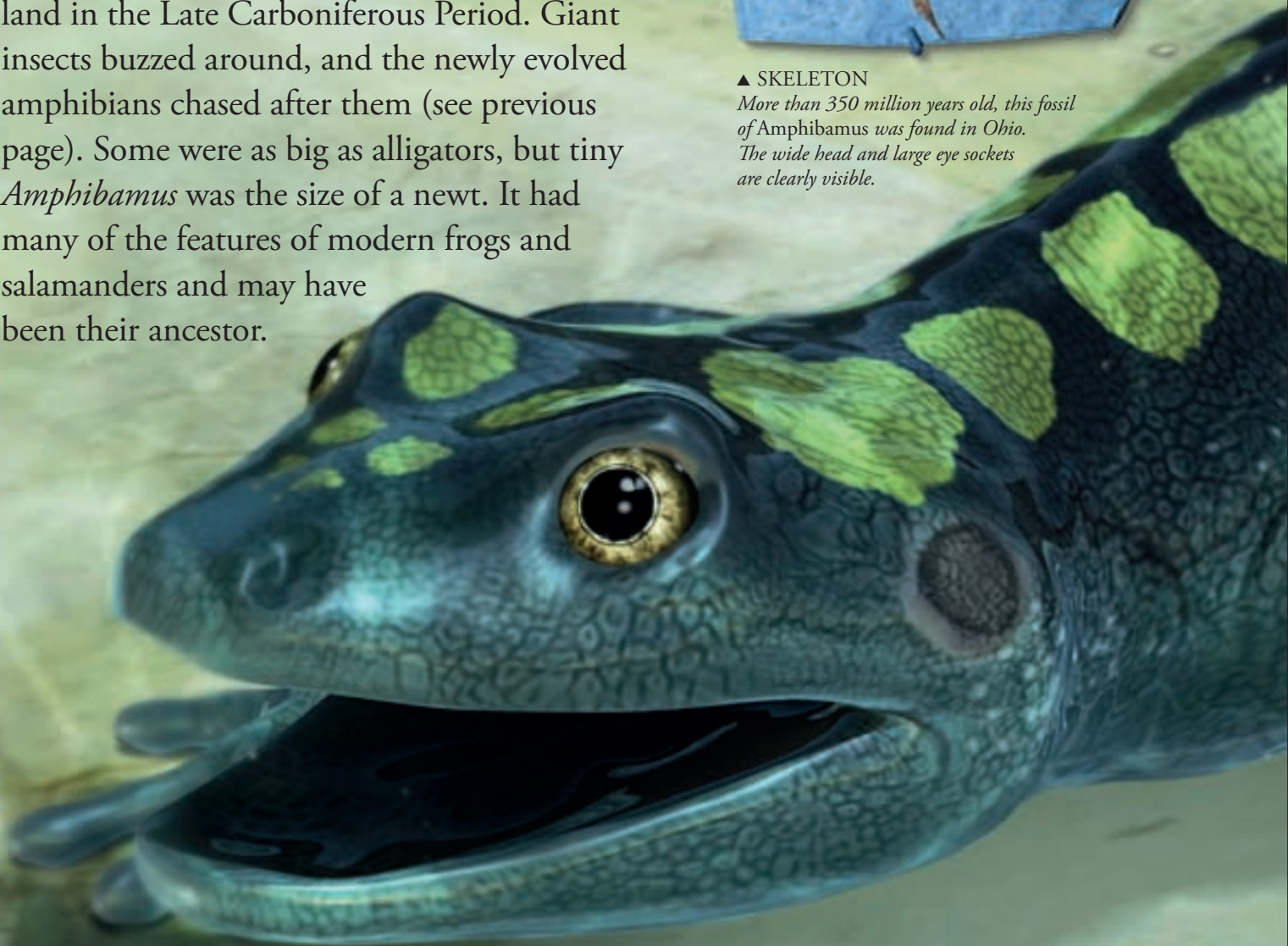


# Amphibamus

Lush tropical forests and swamps covered the land in the Late Carboniferous Period. Giant insects buzzed around, and the newly evolved amphibians chased after them (see previous page). Some were as big as alligators, but tiny *Amphibamus* was the size of a newt. It had many of the features of modern frogs and salamanders and may have been their ancestor.

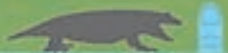
## ▲ SKELETON

More than 350 million years old, this fossil of *Amphibamus* was found in Ohio. The wide head and large eye sockets are clearly visible.



## Amphibamus

AM-fee-bah-muss



- **When** 300 million years ago (Late Carboniferous)
- **Fossil location** USA
- **Habitat** Swamps of N. America and western Europe
- **Length** 6 in (15 cm)
- **Diet** Probably insects

*Amphibamus* had large eyes for spotting prey. Perhaps it hunted by standing still and snatching insects that came close, as frogs do. Like most modern amphibians, it may have had to return to water to breed and lay eggs.

## SKIN BREATHER

*Amphibamus* fossils come from a site that was a river delta in the Carboniferous Period. Perhaps the animal lived in creeks or swamps near the river. Like most amphibians it might have been able to breathe through its moist skin, but it would have had to stay in damp places so its skin didn't dry out.

